

you regular paychecks, filing your taxes is simple. You can use TurboTax, or one of the many available software programs, and upload your W-2 to the site. Or, if you cannot upload, you can simply enter the information from your W-2 into the site where it walks you through the steps. Even my friends who are accountants use these sites because they are so convenient. Again, you need to file this form by April 15 of each year.

Believe it or not, you now know everything you need to know to file your taxes. First, when you get a job, you fill out a W-4 to determine how much money will be taken out of each of your paychecks. Then you work hard for that year and make as much money as possible. At the beginning of the new calendar year, you will be given your W-2 by your employer. You will use the W-2 to fill out a 1040 (using TurboTax or other software). Bam! That's all it takes. Based on how much money you made and how much you paid in taxes during the previous calendar year, you will either get money back or have to pay extra; the tax software will tell you how much. Or, ideally, you will have paid the exact amount required during the year and have a \$0 balance with the IRS.